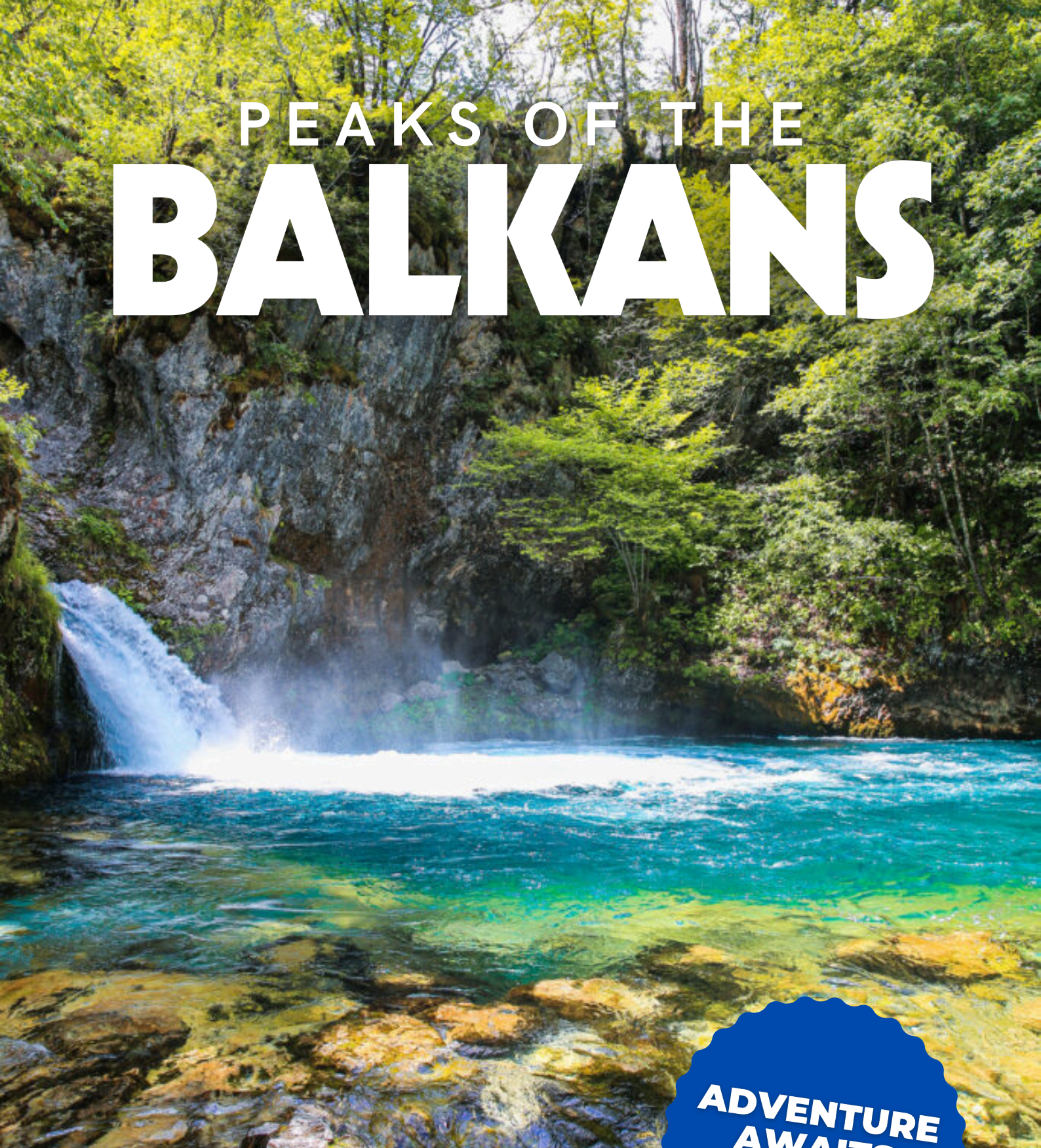


PEAKS OF THE **BALKANS**



**ADVENTURE
AWAITS
ARE YOU IN?**

**ALBANIA, KOSOVO &
MONTENEGRO**

DURATION: 10 DAYS / 9 NIGHTS

DATES: 19–28 AUGUST 2025

GROUP SIZE: MAX 14, MIN 7

DIFFICULTY LEVEL: MODERATE

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THE TRAIL AHEAD

What's Included:

- 10-day Local Guide (English speaking)
- 2 Nights Hotels, 7 Nights shared Guesthouse Rooms
- All Meals (Breakfast, Picnic Lunch, Dinner)
- Airport + Local Transfers
- Luggage Transfers between Stops
- National Park & Border Permits



Day 1 - Welcome to Albania → Arrival in Shkodra

Kickoff mode: ON

Welcome! Are you ready to hike one of Europe's most beautiful transnational trails? After landing at Tirana Airport, we drive north to **Shkodra**, a buzzing northern city with charm for days.

We'll stroll the **Old Boulevard**, soak in those first sips of Balkan culture, and settle into a traditional Albanian hotel. Dinner? It's a proper Northern Albanian feast—comfort food, done the grandma way. Rest up—the mountains are calling.

Day 2 - Lake Koman Ferry → Valbona Valley

Fjords, ferries & first hikes.

After breakfast, we head to **Lake Koman** for a ferry ride through Albania's wildest fjords—turquoise water, limestone cliffs, and that blissful off-grid feeling.

Next stop: **Valbona Valley**—so surreal it feels like nature's private gallery. Towering peaks, riverside trails, and wildflower meadows welcome us into the Alps.

We end the day at a mountain guesthouse with another grand traditional feast—deep flavors, generous portions, unmatched hospitality.



Day 3 - Valbona → Cerem (via Presllopi Pass + Optional Summit)

Peaks, pastures & blueberry stops.

Today, boots hit trail. We climb toward the legendary **Presllopi Pass**, stopping at remote mountain cabins to refuel on homemade yoghurt and wild blueberries.

Feeling strong and skies are clear? We aim for **Kollata e Keqe (2535m)**—Montenegro's highest peak.

We descend into **Cerem**, a quiet alpine village tucked between the pines, where rustic charm and mountain silence wrap around you like a blanket.



Day 4 - Cerem → Dobërdol

Forest paths, border hops & the dreamiest village you've never heard of.

We set off through ancient forests and highland pastures. Today's path dances along the Albania-Montenegro border before leading us to **Dobërdol**.

A tiny alpine village surrounded by peaks, a waterfall, and a crystal-clear lake perfect for a chilly dip. We gather by the fire, share stories under a billion stars, and sleep where the map runs out.



Day 5 - Dobërdol → Gjeravica Summit → Gacaferi Guesthouse

Summit day, glacial dips & pure Kosovo magic.

We cross into **Kosovo** and climb **Gjeravica** (2,656m). Epic 360° views, alpine lakes, and maybe a splash in **Heart Lake**.

We finish at **Gacaferi Guesthouse**, a cozy wooden hut hidden in the forest. Rest those legs you've earned it.



Day 6 - Gacaferi Guesthouse → Three Border Point → Milishevc

Three countries. One ridge. Endless awe.

We hike to **Tropoja Lake** and then the **Three Border Peak**—where Albania, Kosovo, and Montenegro meet.

After ridge trekking through Kosovo's mountains, we descend into **Milishevc**, a peaceful mountain village.



Day 7 - Milishevc → Babino Polje

Wildflowers, woodlands & Montenegro calling.

Today, we cross into **Montenegro** and wander through flower-filled pastures and shady woodlands.

We end the day in **Babino Polje**, a tranquil alpine village with nearby lakes perfect for a fresh dip and mountain feast.

Day 8 - Babino Polje → Karanfili Massif (Grebaje Valley)

Peaks, picnics & the “Dolomites of the Balkans.”

We summit **Popadija**, **Talijanka**, and **Volušnica**—with views of the jagged **Karanfili Massif**. We picnic with panoramic views, then descend to **Grebaje Valley National Park**. Transfer to **Vucetaj Guesthouse** for the night.





Day 9 - Vuthaj → Theth (via Jezerca Lakes)

Border crossings, glacier lakes & echoes of the past.

Crossing back into **Albania**, we trek through the **Prokletije Mountains**, past glacial lakes like **Jezerca**, and WWII-era bunkers.

We arrive in **Theth**, a village where time stands still and stories whisper through the stones.



Day 10 - Explore Theth → Blue Eye → Tirana

Mountain magic, one last swim & the road home.

We explore **Theth National Park**, visiting its iconic church and taking a final swim in the stunning **Blue Eye** spring.

After one last moment of mountain magic, we transfer back to **Tirana** for your departure.



What Others Are Saying

Ally- UK



"Genuinely the best group trip I've ever been on. I went not knowing anyone, but by the first night I felt like I had known everyone forever."

Hannah- UK



"Honestly one of the best trips I've ever been on. The trails we explored were breathtaking with stunning views of the surrounding mountains and valleys. Thank you Fran!!"

Darcey - UK



"A trip I will never forget. I was completely shocked by the beauty this region has to offer. Thank you Fran for making this possible!"

Alice - UK



"Fran's Peak of the Balkans tour was brilliant. Over ten days we explored stunning mountain ranges, stayed in guesthouses, and ate delicious food."

Additional Information



GEAR CHECKLIST

Required Items

- Good hiking shoes
- Daypack (20L–35L)
- Trekking poles
- Sunhat, sunglasses, sunscreen
- Fleece hat, warm fleece jacket
- Rain jacket and pants
- Long-sleeve synthetic shirts
- Trekking trousers
- Antibacterial hand gel
- Personal first aid kit / medications
- 2 x 1L water bottles
- Insect spray
- Water purification tablets

Optional Items

- Tent, sleeping bag, sleeping mat
- Flashlight or headlamp
- Casual shoes, sandals
- Liner socks, spare laces
- Whistle, pocket knife
- Reading or writing materials
- Camera and accessories
- Luggage tags, locks, casual travel wear



DOCUMENTS AND VISAS

Documents Needed

- Airline tickets and itinerary
- Passport

Visa Requirements

- Albania and Kosovo: No visa required for most Western countries
- Montenegro: Check entry requirements



ESSENTIAL TRAVEL INFORMATION

Currency

- Albania: Lek (ALL) – Euro (€) also accepted
- Kosovo & Montenegro: Euro (€)
- Note: Lek can only be bought in Albania

Time Zone

- GMT +1

Electricity

- Voltage: 220V, 50Hz
- Plug type: Two-pin round

ATM Availability While Trekking

- Podgorica
- Shkoder
- Plav



IMPORTANT TRIP CONDITIONS

Health & Age Requirements

- Must be physically fit
- Under 18 must be accompanied by a guardian
- Guesthouse room sharing may occur

Flexibility

- Itineraries are subject to change
- Local guide will make final route decisions

Authority on Tour

- Guide Donat holds decision-making power
- Safety and group dynamics are a priority

Risk Acceptance

- This is an adventure trek; personal risk is inherent



